
North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

November 18, 2024

Mr. Jeff B. Greene
Heritage House Resort and Spa
5200 North Highway 1
Little River, CA 95456
jeff@jeffgreene.com

Dear Mr. Greene,

Subject: Notice of Applicability of General Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ for Heritage House Resort and Spa, Domestic Wastewater System, Little River, Mendocino County

File: Heritage House Domestic Wastewater Systems, 5200 North Highway 1, Little River CA; WDID No. 1B88069RMEN; CIWQS Place No. 230118

This letter serves as the Notice of Applicability (NOA) from the North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Regional Water Board) that General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order) is applicable to the subject wastewater system and that the system is henceforth regulated under the General Order as described below. This letter also provides transmittal of Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) Order No. R1-2024-0008 for the subject wastewater system, Attachment 2 to this NOA.

Heritage House LP (Discharger) submitted a report of waste discharge (ROWD) application on March 15, 2022, for the proposed replacement and upgrade of failing septic tank and leach field wastewater systems serving the Heritage House Resort and Spa (Facility) located at 5200 North Highway 1, Little River, in Mendocino County. Supplemental information was received on July 14, 2023. Based on the information presented in the ROWD and the supplemental information, the proposed upgraded wastewater treatment system and discharge are consistent with the requirements of the General Order.

Henceforth, the Facility discharge is covered by the General Order. The discharge has been subject to Individual Waste Discharge Requirements Order No. 98-122 since December 10, 1998. Regional Water Board action is required for formal rescission of that Order. The Board will consider formal rescission at an upcoming board meeting. Until such time, Regional Water Board staff will evaluate compliance consistent with the terms and conditions of the General Order and in accordance with this NOA.

HECTOR BEDOLLA, CHAIR | VALERIE QUINTO, EXECUTIVE OFFICER

The General Order contains requirements that apply to all types of wastewater systems and requirements that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal systems. **Attachment 1** summarizes the operational requirements and the effluent limitations specific to the Facility's wastewater system. The General Order contains additional requirements not summarized in Attachment 1. Additionally, the General Order requires compliance with Regional Water Board Basin Plan water quality objectives. MRP Order No. R1-2024-0008, **Attachment 2**, contains the necessary site-specific monitoring and reporting requirements. The Discharger is responsible for all applicable requirements in the General Order, this NOA, and MRP Order No. R1-2024-0008.

The General Order is available on the [State Water Resources Control Board \(State Water Board\) website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf) (https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf)

The Regional Water Board Basin Plan, Chapter 3, Water Quality Objectives, is available on the [Regional Water Board website](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/northcoast/water_issues/programs/basin_plan/180710/BPChapter3WaterQualityObjectives.pdf) (https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/northcoast/water_issues/programs/basin_plan/180710/BPChapter3WaterQualityObjectives.pdf)

Facility and Wastewater System Description

The Facility is a 34.5-acre resort located in Little River, California with a restaurant, spa, and 62 guest rooms (Enclosures 1 and 2). Facility wastewater was treated and disposed of via conventional septic tank and leach field systems. These systems have been replaced with a new centralized enhanced wastewater treatment and disposal system, designed to accommodate an average annual wastewater flow of 8,000 gallons per day (gpd) and a maximum day wastewater flow of 15,000 gpd.

The upgraded collection system is comprised of gravity and pressurized sewer lines, anaerobic baffled reactor (ABR) septic tanks for enhanced solids removal efficiency, and effluent pump tanks to convey wastewater to a central treatment facility located on the northeast side of the property.

The central treatment facility includes a recirculation tank, a dual series, three-stage trickling filter and clarifier tank system, and deep bed multi-media filters. Treatment system effluent is collected in a pump tank and disinfected with ultraviolet light. The disinfected effluent is stored in two 10,000-gallon aboveground storage tanks (Enclosure 3). Effluent pumped from the storage tanks is dosed with liquid chlorine for residual disinfection prior to being distributed to seven onsite subsurface drip (SSD) dispersal fields (Enclosure 4). Existing leach fields previously authorized for discharge as per WDR Order No. 98-122, have been rehabilitated for backup disposal capacity.

The wastewater system is equipped with a control panel with a remote monitoring system, alarms, and a backup generator. The Discharger is responsible for ensuring

proper operation, maintenance, and monitoring of the wastewater system.

California Environmental Quality Act

On May 26, 2022, the Mendocino County Coastal Permit Administrator adopted a Mitigated Negative Declaration (SCH No. 2022040344) with a mitigation monitoring plan and approved Coastal Development Permit No. CDP #13-0046 with conditions of approval, for the Facility wastewater system upgrade project. The Mitigated Negative Declaration found that the analysis prepared for the Mitigated Negative Declaration adequately addressed present day environmental concerns pursuant to the provisions of the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA).

Annual Fees

The discharge authorized by this NOA is subject to payment of annual fees under the State Water Board annual fee schedule for regulated waste discharges. Annual fees are based in part on ratings for threat to water quality and complexity, and the treatment technology employed, as defined in the fee schedule listed in California Code of Regulations, Title 23, Division 3, Chapter 9, Waste Discharge Reports and Requirements, Article 1, Fees, Section 2200, Annual Fee Schedules. The annual fee reflects a Threat to Water Quality and Complexity rating of 3C and a 50 percent fee discount because the authorized discharge is a domestic waste discharge of less than 50,000 gallons per day (gpd).

A copy of the current state fee schedule can be downloaded from the [State Water Board](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/docs/fy2223-fee-schedule.pdf) website

(https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/docs/fy2223-fee-schedule.pdf). For more on fees and answers to frequently asked questions please visit the [State Water Board Water Quality Fees](https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wqfees) webpage

(https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/#wqfees)

Questions or concerns about this NOA letter, or related matters, should be directed to Regional Water Board Groundwater Permitting Unit staff, Rachel Prat at Rachel.Prat@waterboards.ca.gov or (707) 576-2542.

Sincerely,

Valerie Quinto
Executive Officer

Heritage House_NOA

Attachments:

1. Summary of WWTS Specific General Order Requirements
2. Monitoring and Reporting Program Order No. R1-2024-0008

Enclosures:

1. Facility Vicinity Map
2. Facility Map
3. Wastewater Treatment Schematic
4. Subsurface Drip Disposal Field Map

cc: Christina Pallmann, Mendocino County Environmental Health, Land Use
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